that tracks all incoming traffic and captures application logs. You should be notified about any problems that arise affecting site availability and performance. Let's look at the key components of that effort:

- *Traffic monitoring*—We can use Vercel's built-in analytics with real-time insights into page views, unique visitors, and performance metrics. However, if you prefer more comprehensive traffic analysis, you can integrate external tools like Google Analytics or Plausible for additional insights. To do this, you want to go to the Analytics page on the Vercel dashboard and enable this for your project.
- *Log management*—For starters, you can use Vercel's detailed logs that allow you to view, search, and inspect logs across different environments. For more advanced log analysis, use external tools like New Relic or Datadog to gain deeper insights into application behavior. This is on the Logs page of the project dashboard.
- *Alerting and notifications*—While Vercel has monitoring features, it does not offer alerting. In that case, you can enhance alerting capabilities by integrating with external services like PagerDuty or Sentry for real-time notifications about critical challenges.
- *Setting up firewall rules*—Vercel offers a simple yet effective web application firewall solution on all plans and can be enhanced by custom rules. For example, you can add a custom rule to log, deny, challenge, bypass, or rate limit traffic to your site. This feature is on the Firewall page of the project dashboard.

Utilizing the basic security and monitoring offerings from Vercel is a very affordable way to ensure your web application remains secure and performant. You get the essentials like HTTPS encryption, detailed monitoring, and automated pipelines all in their free plan. That said, as your app grows, you might want to look beyond Vercel, mainly to have extra eyes on your app's performance and to avoid putting all your eggs in one basket.

Next, for readers interested in exploring different hosting and deployment workflows, we include the details for deploying to Netlify and Hugging Face. Those who are deploying elsewhere or not focusing on deployment details can skip these sections without missing any core content.

9.6.4 Alternative deployments: Netlify

Netlify is a prominent choice for deploying modern web applications. Similar to Vercel, Netlify provides a platform optimized for static sites and serverless functions, offering a seamless and fast deployment experience.

While you can use the Netlify CLI to automate deployments directly from your terminal, the most intuitive way to set up your initial deployment is by using their UI. The web interface guides you through connecting your Git repository (e.g., GitHub, GitLab, or Bitbucket) and configuring your build settings, which is often a more straightforward process for new projects (see figure 9.11).